# Even Step

A new CEA link proposal — what would change for you

For discussion · from January 2027 · 26 weeks · code ES-26-T5

# The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

| 35h | 5 | 14 | 8 of 13 | 30 min |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **the contracted week, as now** | **most days in a row** | **full weekends off a year** | **shift times you already work** | **off every closing shift** |
| no extra hours | up to 7 · today 7–9 | today 10 | 5 new ones | up to 1 hour |

**Same hours, shorter closers, nothing over 8h 30m Monday to Saturday, and never more than five days in a row, cover weeks aside.**

# Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it

### A new timetable in December 2026

More trains, at new times — the new link follows in January 2027.

### More of us on the link

It grows from 20 weeks to 26, so six more colleagues join it.

### New staffing levels

At least 10 on a Sunday, and more at the close and at 22:00. We also aim for 14 on a Saturday.

### The ticket office in fixed pairs

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

**The change is coming whatever we do — the question is which version we want.**

# Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | **35h** |
| Contracted days at work a week | 4.20 | **4.19** |
| Contracted days at work a year | 219.0 | **218.6** |

**No. The same 35-hour week on average; weeks run 25h 30m–42h 00m Monday to Saturday (today 25h 10m–43h 50m), and two more days a year are Saturdays.**

# Will my basic pay change?

Basic pay follows your contracted hours — and a swap for a late earns less overtime

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | **35h** |
| Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter | 26 | **28** |
| Sunday overtime to share — each, a year | 21 | **20** |
| A late against an early, same day, on average | 32 min longer | **▲ 5 min longer** |
| Finishing at 13:35 or 13:45 — each, a year | 26 | **▲ 10** |

**No. Basic pay stays the same. Premium and overtime pay come to about £250 a year less, gross, if you work your share of Sundays. That assumes no swap overtime.**

# Will my shifts be longer?

Closing shifts get shorter, earlies longer — the average goes up about two minutes

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15 | 8h 40m | ✓ 8h 10m |
| Saturday closer — starts 15:45, not 14:45 | 9h 10m | ✓ 8h 10m |
| Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30 | 8h 55m | ✓ 8h 10m |
| Average early, Monday to Saturday | 7h 59m | ▲ 8h 13m |
| Average late, Monday to Saturday | 8h 29m | ✓ 8h 18m |
| Average shift, Monday to Saturday | 8h 14m | ▲ 8h 16m |

**Every closing shift is 30 to 60 minutes shorter; nothing Monday to Saturday runs over 8h 30m, and nothing at all over 9 hours.**

# Will I finish late more often?

3 more a year at 23:00 or later (42, today 39); 16 more at 22:00 or later (94, today 78)

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year | 39 | ▲ 42 |
| Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year | 78 | ▲ 94 |
| Starting at 06:20 — each, a year | 62 | 60 |
| Shortest rest between shifts | 12h 30m | ✓ 14h 35m |

**More people stay on after 22:00 under the December staffing; the three more at 23:00 or later are the fewest the rules allow.**

# Will I know the times?

13 shift times in all — 8 of them you already work

## You work these today (8)

| | |
|---|---|
| 06:20–13:45 | 07:15–15:45 |
| 06:20–14:00 | 08:00–16:30 |
| 06:20–14:20 | 14:00–22:30 |
| 06:20–14:50 | 14:30–22:00 |

## New times (5)

- Closers start later: 30 minutes on weekdays, an hour on Saturdays, 45 minutes on Sundays
- A new weekday late, 12:15–20:30
- Weekends: the ticket-office late, 14:30–22:30
- On Sundays: a 9-hour early, 09:00–18:00

**Fewer shift times than today (13, not 18) — and no early Monday to Saturday is new.**

# Rest and weekends

The biggest improvement over today

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Full weekends off, about a year | 10 | ✓ 14 |
| Most days worked in a row | 7 (up to 9) | ✓ 5 (up to 7) |
| Rest-day breaks of two days or more | 13 of 17 | ✓ 22 of 26 |
| Shortest rest between shifts | 12h 30m | ✓ 14h 35m |
| Weeks on one shift time, all earlies or all lates | 7 of 16 | ✓ 18 of 21 |

**14 full weekends off a year, at most five weeks apart, and never more than five days in a row, cover weeks aside.**

# Your 26 weeks at a glance

The green bars are the full weekends off; where you start is decided later




**Blocks of earlies or lates up to 5 weeks, 7 if the cover weeks go the same way; a full weekend off comes round at least every five weeks.**

# Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Days off in a row — best place to book | 30 | ▲ 28 |
| Days off in a row — on average | 23.4 | 23.4 |
| Days off in a row — worst place | 19 | ✓ 20 |
| Leave for four full weeks off, at best | 14 | ▲ 15 |

**Best stretch 28 days, not 30; four full weeks off in a row, Sunday to Saturday, costs 15 days' leave, not 14. Average the same, worst a day better.**

# More staff on the floor

More people rostered every day, and more at the open and the close on most days

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| On duty on a weekday | 11–12 | ✓ 15 |
| On duty on a Saturday / Sunday | 10 / 8 | ✓ 14 / 10 |
| Fewest rostered on the floor | 2 | ✓ 3 |
| Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside | 4 (up to 5) | ✓ 0 (up to 1) |

**At least three rostered on the floor, and no avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside.**

# The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

### Five new shift times to learn

Three shorter versions of today's lates, a new 8h 15m late and the 9-hour Sunday early.

### Earlies or lates in longer runs

Up to 5 weeks of one kind, 7 if the cover weeks go the same way (today 2, up to 3).

### Four weeks off: 15 days' leave, not 14

The least leave for four complete weeks off in a row, Sunday to Saturday.

### Two more Saturdays a year

28 a year each, today 26 — fourteen on a Saturday, shared across 26 lines.

### More late finishes

42 a year each at 23:00 or later (today 39), and 94 at 22:00 or later (today 78).

### Fewer early finishes and long breaks

10 a year each finish before 14:00 (today 26); no breaks of 3 days or more (today 13 a year).

**None of these is hidden: every figure here is worked out from the rota.**

# At a glance

Same hours and days, shorter closers, more weekends off, fewer days in a row

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | 35h |
| Contracted days at work a year | 219.0 | 218.6 |
| Average shift · longest shift | 8h 14m · 9h 10m | 8h 16m · 9h 00m |
| **Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday** | 8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m | **8h 10m · 8h 10m · 8h 10m** |
| **Full weekends off, about a year** | 10 | **14** |
| **Most days worked in a row** | 7 (up to 9) | **5 (up to 7)** |
| Shortest rest between shifts | 12h 30m | 14h 35m |
| Different shift times | 18 | 13 (8 you know) |
| On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday | 11–12 · 10 · 8 | 15 · 14 · 10 |
| Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside | 4 (up to 5) | 0 (up to 1) |

**The costs: more late finishes, longer runs of earlies or lates and 15 days' leave for four weeks off.**



# What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell S. Silva or your manager what worries you, even if it is small
3. S. Silva, the RMT rep, is leading the change